

# **Anniversaries, Birthdays & Holidays (Traditions) — Interview Practice Questions**

*(answer truthfully; don't guess if unsure).*

## **1) Anniversaries (relationship milestones)**

- When is your anniversary date (and what does it represent: wedding date, engagement date, etc.)?
- How did you celebrate your most recent anniversary?
- Who planned it and what did you do (dinner, trip, gifts, staying in)?
- Did you exchange gifts? What kind (simple, truthful details)?
- Do you usually celebrate on the exact date or the closest weekend?
- Where do you keep any anniversary cards/gifts (drawer, memory box)?

## **2) Birthdays (how you celebrate each other)**

- When is each person's birthday (month/day)?
- How do you typically celebrate each other's birthdays (dinner, cake, family, friends)?
- Who usually plans the birthday celebration?
- Do you usually buy gifts? What kinds of gifts are typical (jewelry, clothes, experiences)?
- Do you go out or stay home more often for birthdays?

## **3) Most recent birthday details (high consistency)**

- What did you do for the most recent birthday you celebrated together?
- Where did you eat (restaurant name or type of food) or what did you cook?
- Was there a cake or dessert? What kind and where did it come from?
- Did you invite anyone or call family/friends? Who?
- What gift was given (or why no gift)?
- Any photos taken? Where are they stored (phone, Google Photos/iCloud)?

## **4) Major holidays you celebrate**

- Which major holidays do you celebrate together (Thanksgiving, Christmas, New Year's, Eid, etc.)?
- Do you celebrate all of them every year or only some?
- Are there any holidays you do not celebrate? Why (religion, family tradition, etc.)?
- Do you celebrate birthdays/holidays differently depending on whether family visits?

## **5) Where you usually go for holidays**

- Where did you spend the most recent major holiday (your home, spouse's family, your family, friends)?
- Do you usually alternate holidays between families? How does that work?
- Who drives/travels and how do you get there?
- If you travel: where do you stay (hotel, family home) and who books it?

## **6) Traditions and routines (meals, church, gifts)**

- Do you have any special holiday traditions (church/service, special prayers, specific events)?
- What special meals do you usually have (turkey, special stew, specific cultural dishes)?
- Who cooks and who helps?
- Do you decorate the home? What decorations and when do you put them up/take them down?
- Do you exchange gifts? Who buys gifts and how do you choose them?

## **7) Guests, hosting, and family involvement**

- Do you host people for holidays? If yes, who comes and how many?
- If you visit family: which relatives do you see most often?
- Do you call or video chat relatives on holidays? Who and how often?
- Do you exchange holiday cards? Where do you keep them?

## **8) Travel and special holiday trips**

- Have you traveled for a holiday together? Where and when?
- Who planned and paid for the trip?
- What did you do on that trip (a few real activities)?
- Any upcoming holiday travel plans?

## **9) "Reality check" questions (recent and specific)**

- What did you do for last New Year's / last Thanksgiving / last Christmas (whichever applies)?
- What was one dish you remember from the last major holiday meal?
- Who did you see or call on the last holiday?
- Did you decorate this year? What did you put up and where in the house?
- What is one tradition you both can describe the same way?

*Tip: If you're not sure about a detail, it's better to say "I don't remember exactly" than to guess.*